

Word family: **secondary / secondarily / secondary school**

Base word: secondary

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**, sometimes **noun**

Related forms / useful extensions:

* **secondary** (adj.) — 次要的；第二階段的；中等教育的；繼發的

* **secondarily** (adv.) — 次要地；其次地

* **secondary school** — 中學

* **secondary education** — 中等教育

* **secondary source** — 第二手資料

* **secondary market** — 二級市場

* **secondary effect** — 次生 / 間接影響

* **secondary infection** — 繼發感染

Important family note:

Although **secondary** is historically related to **second**, I would not merge it into the full **second** family here. In modern usage, **secondary** has several lexicalized meanings of its own that are worth teaching separately.

Meaning in this passage

> My favourite teacher from school was my **secondary school** history teacher, Mr Chan.

Here, **secondary** means:

relating to the stage of education after primary school — 中學的；中等教育的

中文翻譯：

我在學校最喜歡的一位老師，是我**中學時期**的歷史老師陳老師。

So here:

secondary school = 中學

1. **secondary school** — 中學

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> My favourite teacher was my **secondary school** history teacher.

我最喜歡的老師是我的**中學歷史老師**。

Practice 2

> She teaches English at a **secondary school**.

她在一間**中學**教英文。

Practice 3

> I met him when I was in **secondary school**.

我在**中學時期**認識他。

MCQ-ready definition:

secondary school = 小學之後、大學之前的中等教育學校

2. **secondary education** — 中等教育

Practice 1

> He completed his **secondary education** in Hong Kong.

他在香港完成了**中等教育**。

Practice 2

> The government is investing more in **secondary education**.

政府正增加對**中等教育**的投入。

MCQ-ready definition:

secondary education = 小學教育之後、通常在大學或專上教育之前的教育階段

3. **secondary** (次要的) — 次要的；第二重要的

This is one of the major general meanings.

Practice 1

> Cost is a **secondary concern**.

成本只是**次要考慮因素**。

Practice 2

> Safety is the main issue; appearance is **secondary**.

安全是主要問題，外觀是**次要的**。

MCQ-ready definition:

secondary = 重要性、優先次序或地位低於主要事物的

4. **secondary role / importance — 次要角色 / 重要性較低**

Practice 1

> He played a **secondary role** in the project.

他在這個項目中扮演**次要角色**。

Practice 2

> Price was of **secondary importance**.

價格只是**次要考慮**。

MCQ-ready definition:

secondary role/importance = 並非主要或最重要的地位

5. **secondary effect / consequence — 次生 / 間接影響**

Practice 1

> The policy had several **secondary effects**.

這項政策帶來了幾個**次生影響**。

Practice 2

> Rising prices created **secondary consequences** for small businesses.

物價上升對小型企業造成了**間接後果**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****secondary effect/consequence = 由主要事件或變化進一步引起的間接結果****

6. ****secondary cause — 次要原因****

Practice 1

> Stress was a ****secondary cause**** of the problem.

壓力是這個問題的****次要原因****。

Practice 2

> Poor communication was only a ****secondary factor****.

溝通不足只是一個****次要因素****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****secondary cause/factor = 有影響，但不是最主要的原因或因素****

7. ****secondary source — 第二手資料****

A very important academic use.

Practice 1

> The article is a ****secondary source****.

這篇文章屬於****第二手資料****。

Practice 2

> Students should compare primary and ****secondary sources****.

學生應比較第一手和****第二手資料****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****secondary source = 根據第一手資料作分析、解釋或整理而形成的資料來源****

8. **secondary research** — 第二手研究；案頭研究

Practice 1

> We began with **secondary research** before conducting interviews.

我們在進行訪談前，先做了**第二手資料研究**。

Practice 2

> **Secondary research** can save both time and money.

第二手研究可以節省時間和金錢。

MCQ-ready definition:

secondary research = 使用現有資料、報告或研究成果進行的研究，而非直接收集原始數據

9. **secondary market** — 二級市場

A finance/business sense.

Practice 1

> The shares are traded on the **secondary market**.

這些股票在**二級市場**交易。

Practice 2

> Investors can buy bonds in the **secondary market**.

投資者可以在**二級市場**購買債券。

MCQ-ready definition:

secondary market = 已發行的證券在投資者之間買賣的市場

10. **secondary infection** — 繼發感染

A common medical sense.

Practice 1

> The wound developed a **secondary infection**.

傷口出現了**繼發感染**。

Practice 2

> Doctors were concerned about a **secondary infection**.

醫生擔心會出現**繼發感染**。

MCQ-ready definition:

secondary infection = 在原有疾病、傷口或感染之後進一步出現的另一種感染

11. **secondary disease / condition — 繼發性疾病 / 狀況**

Practice 1

> The condition may be **secondary to** another illness.

這種情況可能是由另一種疾病**繼發**引起的。

Practice 2

> The symptoms were found to be **secondary to** an underlying problem.

這些症狀後來發現是由一個潛在問題**繼發**造成的。

MCQ-ready definition:

secondary to X = 由 X 引起、作為 X 的後續或繼發結果

12. **secondary colour — 間色 ; 二次色**

A standard art/design sense.

Practice 1

> Green is a **secondary colour**.

綠色是一種**間色 / 二次色**。

Practice 2

> **Secondary colours** are made by mixing primary colours.

間色是由原色混合而成的。

MCQ-ready definition:

secondary colour = 由兩種原色混合而成的顏色

13. **secondary storage — 次級儲存；輔助儲存**

A computing sense.

Practice 1

> Hard drives are used for **secondary storage**.

硬碟用作**次級儲存裝置**。

Practice 2

> **Secondary storage** keeps data even when the power is off.

次級儲存可在斷電後保留資料。

MCQ-ready definition:

secondary storage = 用來長期保存資料、不同於主要記憶體的儲存系統

14. **secondary character / supporting role — 次要角色**

In stories, film, drama, etc.

Practice 1

> He plays a **secondary character** in the film.

他在電影中飾演一個**次要角色**。

Practice 2

> The novel gives several **secondary characters** important moments.

小說給了幾個**次要人物**不少重要戲份。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****secondary character = 不是故事主要人物，但仍對情節有一定作用的角色****

15. ****secondary objective — 次要目標****

Practice 1

> Our main goal is safety; speed is a ****secondary objective****.

我們的主要目標是安全，速度只是****次要目標****。

Practice 2

> Reducing costs was a ****secondary objective****.

降低成本是一個****次要目標****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****secondary objective = 重要性低於主要目標的附加目標****

16. ****secondary (noun: secondary school student / secondary stage) — 中學階段 / 次級部分****

As a noun, ****secondary**** exists in some specialized or regional uses, but it is far less central than the adjective.

For learner purposes, the important productive use is mostly in compounds such as:

- * secondary school
- * secondary education
- * secondary source
- * secondary market

So I would ****not over-expand the noun use**** unless a future passage specifically gives us one.

Important distinction 1: ****secondary vs second****

****second****

usually means ordinal position:

> the second lesson

> 第二課

secondary

usually means:

* lower in importance

* relating to a later stage

* derived from something primary

> a secondary issue

> 次要問題

So **secondary ≠ simply “second”**. .

Important distinction 2: **secondary vs primary**

This is the central contrast.

primary

main / first / original

secondary

less important / later / derived

Examples:

* primary school ↔ secondary school

* primary source ↔ secondary source

* primary effect ↔ secondary effect

Important distinction 3: **secondary vs minor**

secondary

lower in rank or importance relative to something primary.

minor

small or not serious/important.

> a secondary issue

次要問題

> a minor problem

小問題

A secondary issue may still be quite serious.

Important distinction 4: **secondary vs supporting**

In stories or roles:

secondary

not primary/main.

supporting

specifically helps support the main role or structure.

They often overlap, but not always.

Important distinction 5: **secondary source vs second-hand information**

These are related but not identical.

secondary source

formal academic term:

analysis or interpretation based on primary sources.

second-hand information

information received indirectly from someone else.

So a newspaper article may be a secondary source academically, while casual gossip is second-

hand information.

Important distinction 6: ****secondary school vs middle school / high school****

These are education-system terms, not exact universal equivalents.

****secondary school****

broadly = school after primary education.

Depending on country, it may overlap with:

* middle school

* junior high

* high school

In your Hong Kong-style passage, ****secondary school = 中學**** is exactly right.

Important distinction 7: ****secondary effect vs side effect****

****secondary effect****

a later or indirect effect.

****side effect****

an additional unintended effect, especially of medicine.

They overlap sometimes, but they are not interchangeable.

Important distinction 8: ****secondary infection vs recurring infection****

****secondary infection****

arises after or because of an earlier condition.

****recurring infection****

keeps coming back.

Not the same.

Important distinction 9: **secondary to X**

This structure is especially common in medicine and formal explanation:

> symptoms **secondary to** infection

= symptoms caused by the infection

So:

secondary to = arising because of; caused by

This is different from ordinary:

> secondary importance

= lower importance

Important distinction 10: **secondary market vs primary market**

primary market

securities are issued for the first time.

secondary market

existing securities are traded between investors.

The word **secondary** here means “after the initial issue,” not “less important.”

Important distinction 11: **secondary colour vs darker/lighter colour**

A **secondary colour** is a technical art term based on colour mixing.

It does not mean:

* less vivid

* less important

* darker

So this is a domain-specific lexical meaning.

Important distinction 12: **secondary education vs higher education**

secondary education

schooling after primary school.

higher education

university/college-level education.

Do not confuse them.

Family-extension note

Secondary has a very clear semantic architecture built around the idea:

coming after, depending on, or ranking below something primary

The major branches are:

1. **education stage**

- * secondary school
- * secondary education

2. **importance/rank**

- * secondary concern
- * secondary role
- * secondary objective

3. **derived/indirect**

- * secondary effect
- * secondary cause

4. **academic information**

- * secondary source
- * secondary research

5. **technical/domain-specific**

- * secondary market
- * secondary infection
- * secondary colour
- * secondary storage

These are connected, but some are lexicalized enough to require separate teaching.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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secondary school	中學	education after primary
secondary education	中等教育	secondary-stage schooling
secondary concern	次要考慮	lower importance
secondary role	次要角色	non-main role
secondary objective	次要目標	lower-priority goal
secondary effect	次生 / 間接影響	indirect result
secondary cause	次要原因	non-primary cause
secondary source	第二手資料	based on primary sources
secondary research	第二手研究	uses existing data
secondary market	二級市場	resale/trading market
secondary infection	繼發感染	later infection
secondary to X	由 X 繼發 / 造成	caused by X
secondary colour	間色 / 二次色	mixed from primary colours
secondary storage	次級儲存	non-primary memory/storage
secondary character	次要角色	non-main character

For your original sentence

> My favourite teacher from school was my **secondary school** history teacher, Mr Chan.

Here:

secondary = 中學的 ; 屬於中等教育階段的

So:

> **secondary school history teacher = 中學歷史老師**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 我在學校最喜歡的一位老師，是我**中學時期的歷史老師**陳老師。

For this passage, the exact sense is the straightforward **education-stage** meaning of **secondary**.